

corrupt government. The question before us is not where the money came from but what to do with it now?

Moved by a sense of fairness, incompetence, or public service, many rich people will shirk their responsibilities and shuck their wealth. But successful Old Money knows better.

MOST CHARITY IS A WASTE OF TIME AND MONEY

We are racing ahead. We haven't told you how to make a fortune or how to manage it yet. But we are telling you what to do once you have one. Why? Because it shows you how difficult it is to do what you're trying to do. The more money you have, the more reasons you find to get rid of it. You think you're being smart by investing it. You think you are being cool by spending it. You think you are being good by giving it away.

Often, you might just as well throw it down a storm drain.

Most people with money have no reason to feel guilty or proud. They were neither particularly smart nor particularly greedy. They were just lucky. And they are not likely to do any good by giving their money away or advocating higher tax rates on the rich—unless, of course, they actually want to give it away or pay it in taxes. If they do, it merely shows that they are not fit to have it. Better to move it along to more able hands. What the hell? Spend it.

Ultimately, the government is responsible for tilting the playing field. Why reward the culprits with higher tax revenues? As for giving the money to charity, good luck with that. It's hard enough to manage, preserve, and pass along money to your own family. Try doing it for someone else's family. Most likely, you'll do more harm than good.

Or maybe you think you'd like to find a cure for cancer? Pay for a new gym at a local college? Provide scholarships for the children of one-armed paperhangers? Good luck again. The world is full of people who want to get ahead. Everyone wants as much power, status, and money as possible, with the least effort. Some work for the government. Some for private business.